



MONTHLY UPDATE

Energy: monthly update, August 2026

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10 places. Every block below is carried verbatim from that place's own monthly update, where it was written, sourced and checked; nothing is written here.

BOTSWANA · BURUNDI · ETHIOPIA · LESOTHO · MAURITIUS · MOZAMBIQUE · SIERRA LEONE · SOUTH AFRICA ·
UGANDA · ZIMBABWE

Botswana

The facility's power is the unusual part. On-site gas-fired generation is supplemented by solar introduced to cover periods of lower gas availability, with battery and compressed-gas storage under review — solar specified as firming for gas, the reverse of the usual diesel-backup arrangement. An initial 5 MW solar development was assessed during the quarter and an extension of the gas gathering network to connect a further production well is stated subject to funding; neither carries a capital cost, approval or date, and the company states both are work-programme items rather than guidance. The second gates the data centre: capacity growth turns on upstream gas work rather than on demand.

Burundi

Among the regulator's remedies for degraded service, named on 3 August, is a planned study on powering mobile base stations.

Ethiopia

The incumbent's renewable programme reached 39.72 MW of installed solar across 190 fully solar-powered sites, 867 hybrid systems and 1,114 lithium-ion storage units, 12.72 MW of it added over the financial year, with diesel generator running time down by up to 40%. The figures are the operator's own and unaudited.

Lesotho

The electricity corporation states it has held supply availability above 99 per cent on the transmission network and around 95 per cent on distribution for the past years, attributing the faults that remain to an ageing network and to weather. The figures are the utility's own and the base holds nothing that tests them.

Mauritius

Cabinet also approved for signature a memorandum with Saudi Arabia putting digital transformation and energy-sector cybersecurity alongside hydrocarbons — an approval to sign, not a signature, with no date, term, value or committed system stated.

Mozambique

The same data centre draws on grid, photovoltaic and generator supply ([inauguration account](#)).

Sierra Leone

The constraint under everything else eased slightly. A World Bank-funded [40MW solar-plus-storage project at Lungi and Newton became fully operational, commissioned in July 2026 and projected to raise the electricity access rate toward 36%](#) and to ease the outages that interrupt telecommunications and digital services. The access projection is the project's own; no generation outturn, grid-availability series or measured effect on network uptime is held, so the connection between the plant and the services it is said to protect is asserted rather than shown.

South Africa

The grid had its best month on the utility's own reporting in six years. Eskom [put the energy availability factor at 67.55%, its highest in six years, with unplanned outages down 44.5% year on year, about 1.2 million customers removed from load reduction and 505,607 smart meters installed](#), the Eastern Cape becoming the seventh province removed from load reduction. These are the utility's figures and no regulator or system-operator confirmation accompanies them.

It closes a build programme rather than opening one: the last unit of the two flagship stations [entered commercial operation in September 2025, adding 800 MW](#). What the month does not settle is adequacy after 2029, which the system operator's own assessment identifies as the risk and which is carried in the progress report rather than here.

Uganda

The largest operator's 2025 sustainability report puts [45% of network sites on solar or hydro, with a 490 kWh solar plant commissioned at headquarters](#). The [figures are the company's own and unaudited](#), and no prior-year share is held against which to read that share.

Zimbabwe

The listed infrastructure company commenced phase 1 of a 100 MW solar farm for its technology park, and its fuel-management system was credited with reducing energy consumption on tower sites, with no percentage, litre, cost or uptime figure given ([trading update](#)).

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